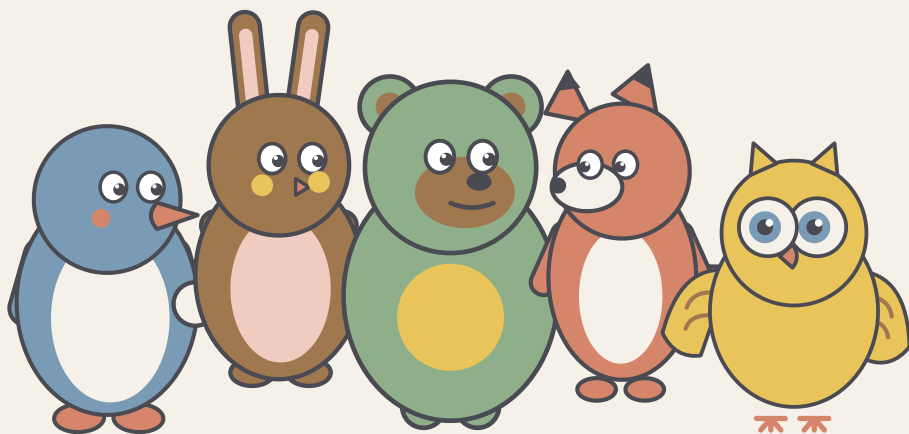


Words Are Everywhere

A gentle first grammar book for curious children

by dio.stesso



A NOTE FOR YOU

Turns out writing a book is easier than convincing someone to publish it.

So I skipped that part.

I wrote these books for my favourite people. Since you're here, I'm assuming that's you.

They're free until a publisher discovers my existence, offers me a contract, and starts sending royalty cheques.

Enjoy the book. If you like it, drop me a note. If you love it—or if it sparks a new idea for someone you love—Hot Wheels and LEGO remain valid currency in my kingdom.

 **dio.stesso**

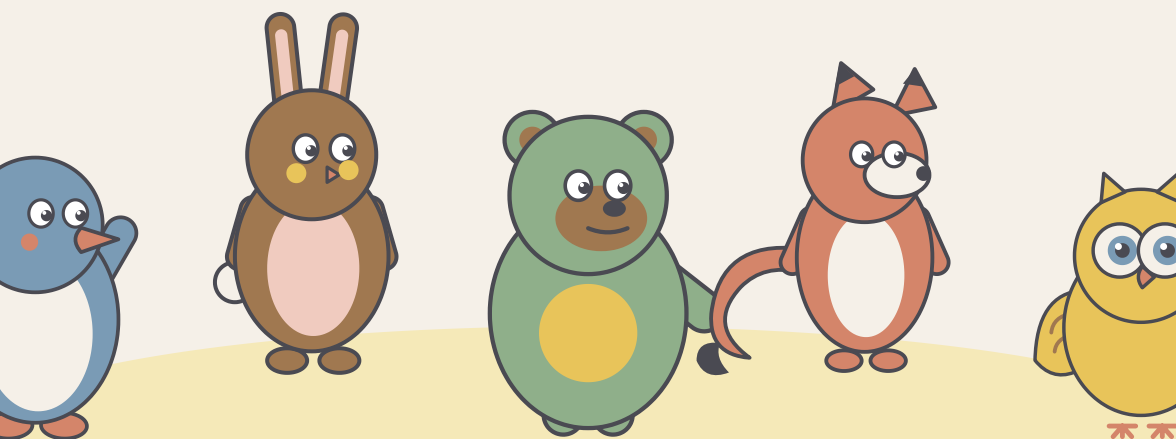
code.dio.stesso@gmail.com



Words Are Everywhere

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Eight little adventures with words



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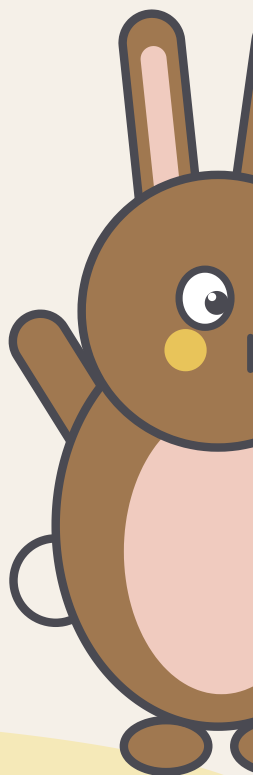
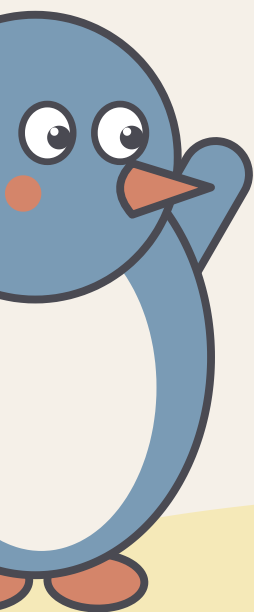
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PART 1

Words & Sentences





Words name things and do things

Every day you use hundreds of words. Some words name things, like **apple** and **dog**. Other words show actions, like **run** and **jump**. You already do this all the time, without even thinking. Words are how we share what we see and what we do.



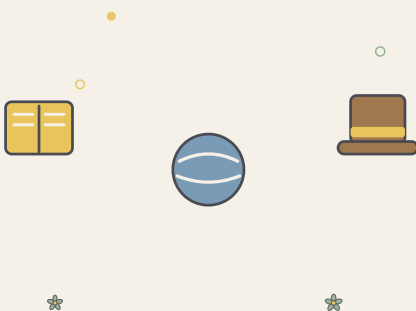
 Say one naming word, then one doing word, out loud.

Words are everywhere you look

Look around the room.

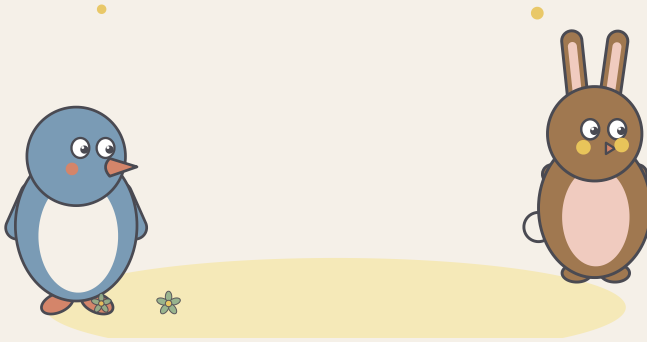
There is a word for the
chair you sit on and the
cup you drink from.

There is a word for
what you do too: **sit**,
hold, **smile**. Everything
you can see or do
already has a word
waiting for it.





🍃 Point to three things and say the word for each one.



A sentence is a whole idea

When words work together to say a complete thought, that is a sentence. **Pip sleeps.** tells us who and what. **Nora hops high.** does too. One word can say a little, but a sentence says a whole idea, all the way through.



 Say a tiny sentence about yourself, like I jump.

Every sentence starts tall

The first letter of a sentence stands up tall. We call it a capital letter. **The** sun is warm. **Pip** is happy.

Names wear tall letters too, wherever they sit — **Nora**, **Milo**, **Toby**. A capital says: something new begins here!

...



🍃 Find a tall capital letter at the start of a sentence.



Three little marks end a sentence

At the end of a sentence sits a tiny mark. A full stop . means calm and finished. A question mark ? is asking something. An exclamation mark ! is full of feeling. Each one tells your voice exactly what to do.



🍃 Say a sentence, then clap where its end mark would go.

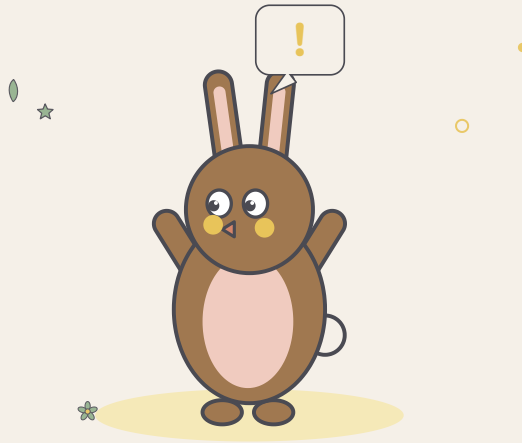


Which mark fits here?

Listen to your voice choose. **Toby is sleepy** feels calm — a full stop. **Are you ready** is asking — a question mark. **We did it** is exciting — an exclamation mark! Same words can wear different marks, and each one sounds different.



🍃 Say one sentence three ways: calm, asking, then excited!



Some words pop out!

Sometimes a feeling jumps straight out as a word of its own. **Wow! Oops! Yay! Oh!** These little words show surprise, joy, or a wobble. They almost always bring an exclamation mark along for the ride.



🌿 Say Wow! as if you just saw something amazing.

Wow! Oops! Yay!

Feeling words pop up everywhere. **Hooray!** we shout when we win. **Oops!** we say when we wobble. **Shh.** we whisper when it is quiet. These surprising little words are called interjections. They let your feelings speak first.



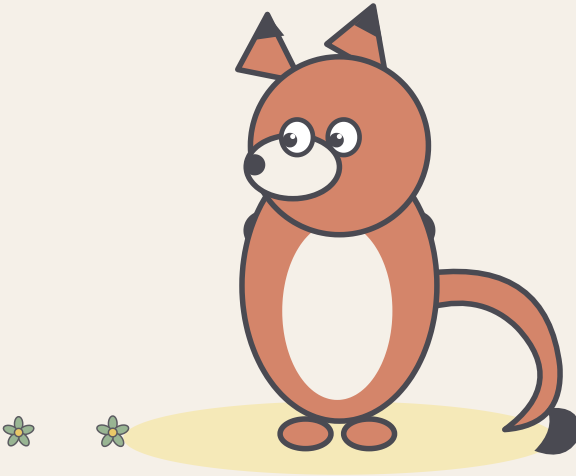
🍃 Say a feeling word for something happy and something silly.

Can you make a sentence?

Let us build one together. Start with a name: **Milo**.

Add an action: **runs**. Say them together — Milo runs!

That is a whole sentence. Now make your own. Pick anyone you like and tell us what they do.



🍃 Make a sentence using your own name and one action word.

Look how much you know!

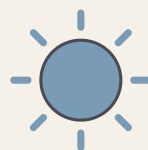
In just a few pages you learned that **words** name things and do things, that a **sentence** is a whole idea, and that little marks and feeling words help it along. Remember — you already use all of this every single day.

..



Remember one new thing you learned. Tell someone about it!

PART 2



Naming Words





Everything has a name

Look around you. The thing you sit on has a name: **chair**. The thing you drink from: **cup**. The soft thing on your bed: **pillow**. Every single thing you can point to has a word that names it. You know hundreds of them already!



🍃 Point to three things near you and name each one out loud.

People, places, things

Names come in lovely kinds. People have names, like **friend** and **teacher**. Places have names, like **park** and **home**. Things have names too, like **apple** and **ball**. So many names, all around you, all the time.



 Name one person, one place, and one thing you love.

A noun names a thing

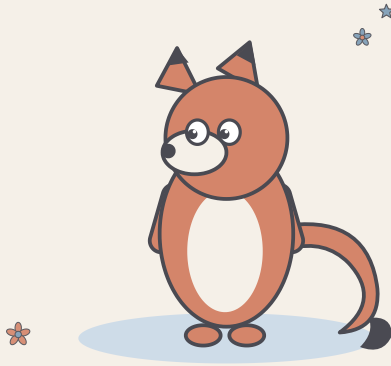
Every word you just used has something in common. **apple**, **park**, **friend**, **ball** — you can point to each one, or picture it in your mind. Words that name people, places, and things have a special name of their own.



Words that name people, places, or things are called nouns.



🍂 Find a noun in the room right now. Say it out loud!



Some names are special

Most nouns are everyday names, like **dog** or **city**. But the name of one special dog, like **Milo**, or one special place, like **London**, is extra special. These always begin with a capital letter, because there is only one of them.



🍃 Say your own special name. It begins with a capital!

Pip is a proper noun

A special name is called a proper noun. **Pip** is one. **Monday** is one. So is **Africa** and the name of your very best friend. Notice how every one wears a tall capital letter, proudly, wherever it stands.



 Name a special day or place. Does it start with a capital?



One thing, or many

When there is just one, we use the plain name: **one cat**, **one star**. When there is more than one, the word changes a little: **two cats**, **three stars**. Did you hear the soft -s slip onto the end? That tiny sound means more than one.



🍃 Hold up one finger, then two. Say one cat, then two cats.



One apple... two apples

Watch the magic -s appear. One **apple** becomes two **apples**. One **ball** becomes three **balls**. One **tree** becomes a whole row of **trees**. Just a tiny sound at the end, and suddenly there are more!



 Say one ball, then two balls. Did you hear the -s?

Add -s or -es to make more

You have heard it again and again. **cat** becomes **cats**. **box** becomes **boxes**. Most of the time we add a small -s. When a word already hisses or buzzes at the end, we add -es so it is easy to say.



To show more than one, add -s or -es to a noun.

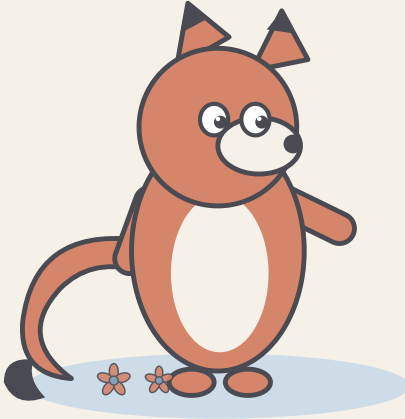


🍃 Notice something nearby that ends in -s. That is a plural!

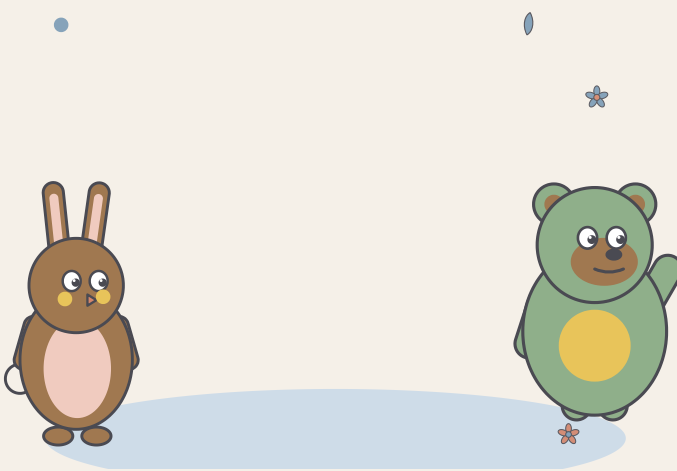
Name everything you can see

Time for a naming game! Look slowly around the room. Every time your eyes land on something, say its name out loud. **lamp**. **window**. **shoe**. **book**. Each one is a noun. How many can you find before you run out of breath?

..



🍃 Count how many nouns you can name in ten seconds. Go!



You know so many names!

Remember the big idea: a **noun** names a person, place, or thing. Special names, called proper nouns, wear capital letters. And to make more than one, we add a little -s. You name the world without even trying.



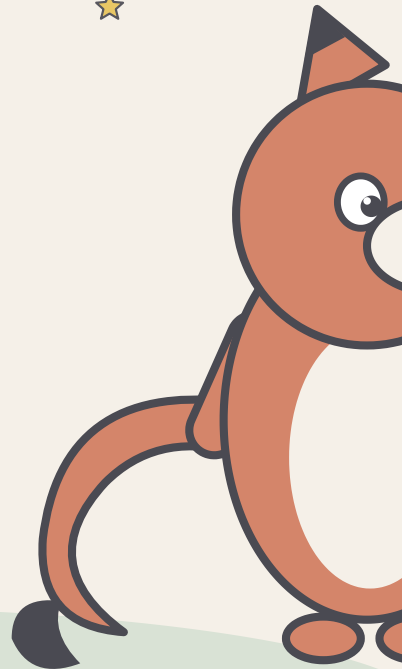
Remember a noun from this part. Say it and point to it!

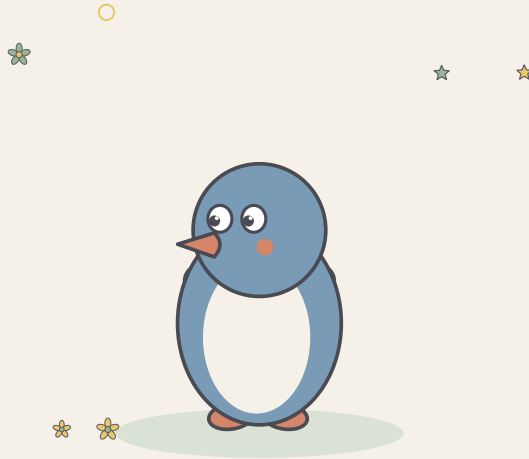


PART 3



Stand-in Words



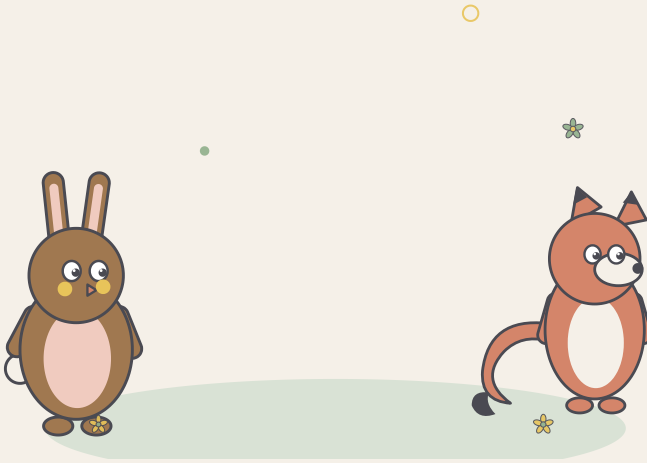


Short words that stand in

Instead of saying a name again and again, we use a short stand-in word. We do not say **Pip is happy, so Pip hops**. We say **Pip is happy, so he hops**! The little word **he** stands in for the whole name, Pip. These tiny helpers save us from repeating ourselves.



🍃 Say a friend's name, then say she or he instead.



He, she, it, they

Stand-in words are everywhere. **He** runs. **She** sings. **It** barks. **They** play together. Each one stands in for a name we already know. Small as they are, they keep our sentences smooth and easy to say.



🍃 Point to a friend and say they. Point to a toy and say it.

A pronoun stands in for a name

Think of the little
stand-ins you just met.

he, she, it, they, we,
you. Each one takes the
place of a noun, so we
do not have to say the
same name over and
over.



Words that stand in for a noun are called pronouns.



 Say your friend's name, then a pronoun that stands in for it.

His, her, my — who it belongs to

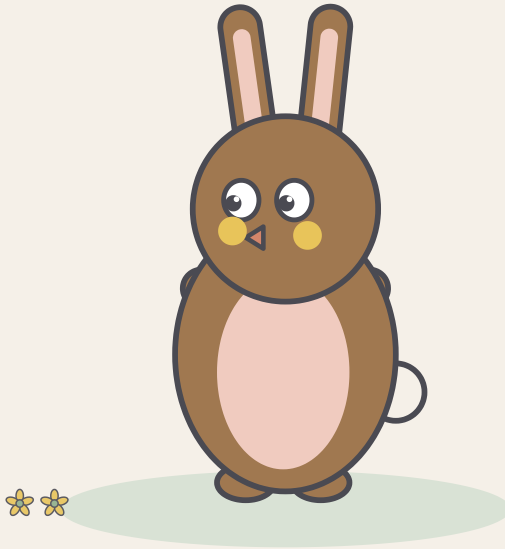
Some stand-in words show who something belongs to. We do not say **Pip's hat** over and over — we say **his** hat. Nora's book becomes **her** book. The ball that belongs to you is **your** ball, and the one that is mine is **my** ball. So: **he** and **she** tell who does something; **his** and **her** tell who it belongs to.



🍌 Point to something of yours and say my. Point to a friend's and say his or her.

Spot the stand-in word

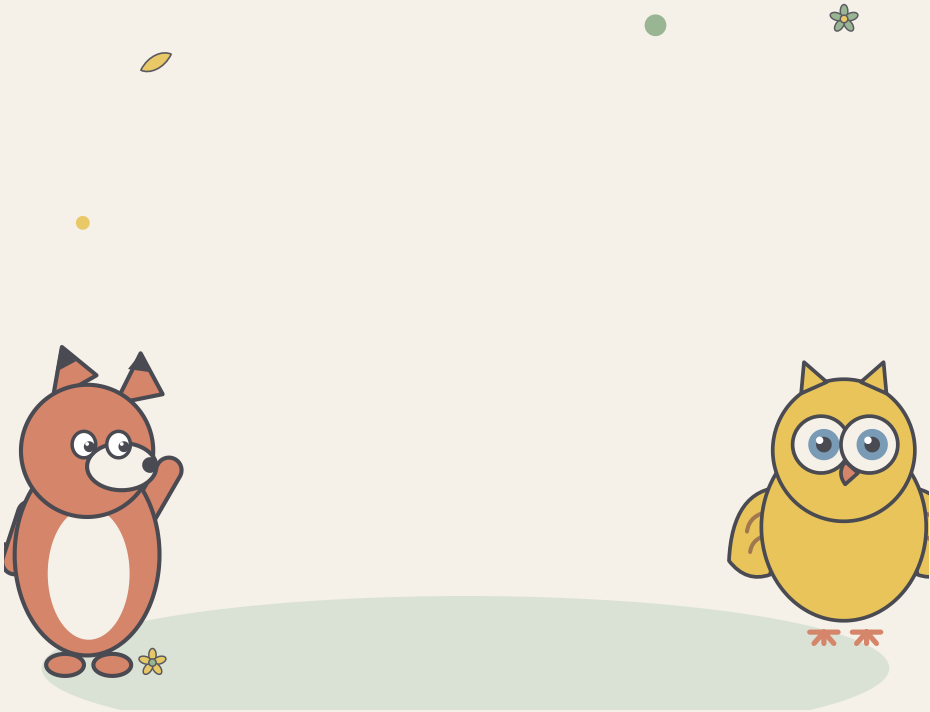
Listen like a detective. In **Nora is happy, so she hops**, can you hear the stand-in word? It is **she** — and she means Nora! Pronouns hide in almost every sentence. Once you start listening, you will hear them everywhere.



🍃 Spot one pronoun in a sentence someone says to you.

Tiny words, big help!

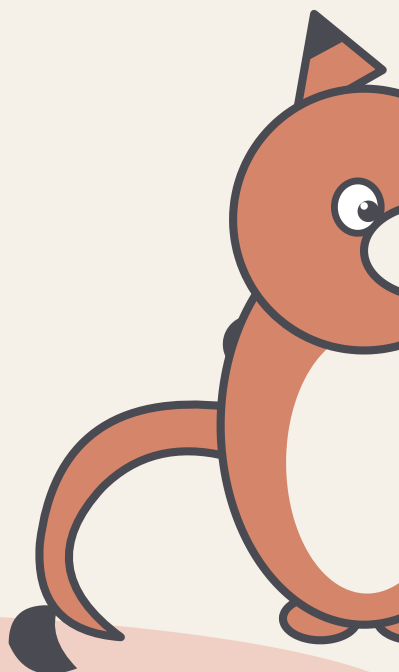
Remember the stand-ins? **he**, **she**, **it**, **they** tell us who does something. **his**, **her**, **my**, **your** tell us who it belongs to. Both kinds stand in for a name, so we do not have to say it over and over.



Remember a pronoun. Use it in a little sentence!

PART 4

Doing Words





Some words show what happens

Nouns name things — but some words do something. **run. jump. laugh. eat.** Say them and you almost want to move! These busy words tell us what someone is doing. Your whole day is full of them.



🍃 Do one action right now. Can you name it out loud?

Run. Jump. Think. Eat.

Actions can be big or small. Big ones you can see: **run**, **jump**, **dance**. Small ones happen quietly: **think**, **dream**, **wish**. Whether loud or still, every action is something happening. So much is always happening!



 Act out one action word, then whisper one quiet one.

Action words are called verbs

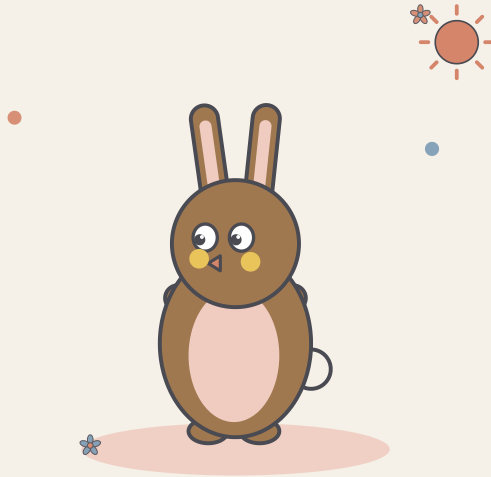
Think back to the busy words. **run**, **eat**, **think**, **jump**. Every one tells what someone does. Words like these, the ones full of doing, have a name all their own.



Words that tell what someone does are called verbs.



 Act out one of the verbs from this page!



Happening right now

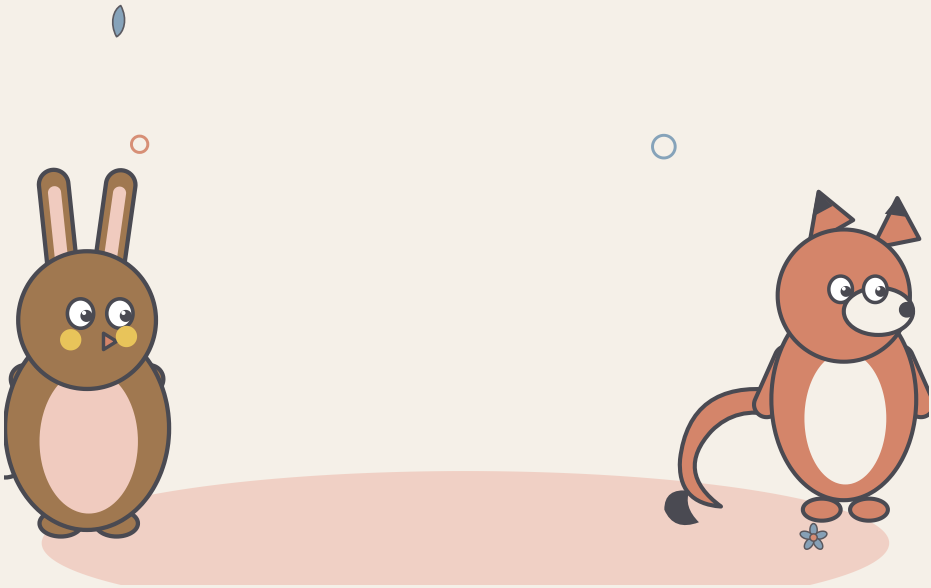
Some actions are happening this very second. **Nora is jumping. Milo is sitting. The sun is shining.** When something is going on right now, we say it like this. Look — it is happening as you read!



🍃 Say what you are doing right now: I am ____.

Nora is jumping right now

Right now, look what everyone is up to. **Nora is jumping** for joy. **Milo is sitting** in the sun. **Pip is pointing** at a star. All of it is happening now, in this very moment, together.



🌿 Tell someone what they are doing right now.



Already happened

Some actions are already over and done. We use special words for those. **Toby jumped. He walked home. Pip waved.** Can you hear the little -ed at the end? It means it happened before — in the past.



🍃 Say something you did this morning, like I woke up.



Toby jumped. He walked home.

Yesterday was full of doing. **Toby jumped** over a log. He **walked** all the way home. He **played** until the sun went down. Each -ed tells us it already happened. The day is done, but the words remember it.



 Say three things you did yesterday. Listen for the -ed!



Not yet — but it will

Some actions have not happened yet, but they will!

We use the little word will. **Luna will fly. Pip will**

swim. We will play. It is like a tiny promise about the future, waiting just ahead of you.

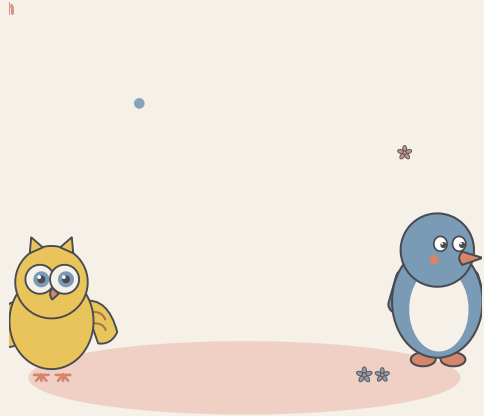


🍃 Say one thing you will do tomorrow.

Luna will fly. Pip will swim.

The future is full of plans. **Luna will fly** high above the trees.

Pip will swim in the cool sea. **Toby will nap** under a tree. Each will points to something happy that is coming very soon.



 Imagine tomorrow. Say one thing that will happen.

Past, now, and next

A verb can tell us when. **jumped** already happened. **is jumping** is happening now. **will jump** has not happened yet. The same action can live in the past, the present, or the future. These are called tenses.



Verbs change to show time: past, present, and future.



🍃 Say one verb three ways: past, now, and next!

Do an action. Name it!

Stand up if you can! Do an action — wiggle, clap, spin, or hop. Now freeze and name it: I am **clapping**! Try another one. Then tell what you just did: I **clapped**! You are using verbs with your whole body.



 Act out a verb and ask someone to guess which one it is.

So many things can happen!

Remember the doing words? A **verb** tells what someone does. It can happen now, like **jumping**. It can be over, like **jumped**. Or it can be coming, like **will jump**. Past, now, and next — you can say them all.



Remember a verb. Say it in the past, now, and future!

PART 5



Describing Words





Words that paint pictures

Some words add colour to what we say. Not just a **ball**, but a **red** ball. Not just a **bear**, but a **soft**, **sleepy** bear. These words paint a picture in someone's mind. You use them to share exactly what you see.



 Describe something near you using a colour word.

Big bear. Small apple. Blue sky.

Describing words are everywhere. A **big** bear. A **small** apple. A **blue** sky. A **loud** drum. A **fluffy** cloud. Each little word tells us more — how big, what colour, how it feels. The world gets clearer.





✎ Add one describing word to the noun apple.

Describing words are adjectives

Think of all those extra words. **big**, **red**, **soft**, **loud**, **happy**. Each one describes a noun and tells us more about it. Words that do this have a special name.



Words that describe a noun are called adjectives.



 Say one adjective that describes you today.



Even more, even less

Adjectives can grow! Something can be **big**.

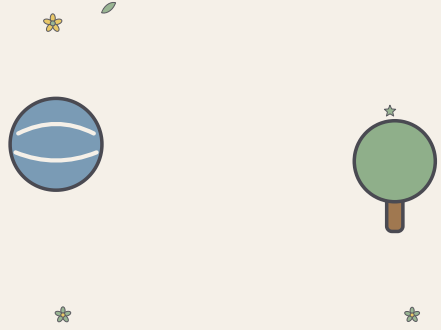
Something else can be **bigger**. And one thing can be the **biggest** of all. Add a little -er to compare two, and -est for the very top. Your words can measure the world.



🍃 Say something small, then something even smaller.

Big. Bigger. Biggest.

Watch a word climb. A mouse is **small**. A cat is **bigger**. An elephant is the **biggest** of the three. **fast, faster, fastest. tall, taller, tallest.** Step by step, the word grows.



🍃 Compare two toys. Which one is bigger?



Opposites and almost-the-same

Some adjectives are opposites: **hot** and **cold**, **fast** and **slow**, **happy** and **sad**. Others are close friends that mean almost the same: **big** and **large**, **glad** and **happy**. So many ways to describe one thing!



🍃 Say an adjective, then say its opposite.



Words that tell how

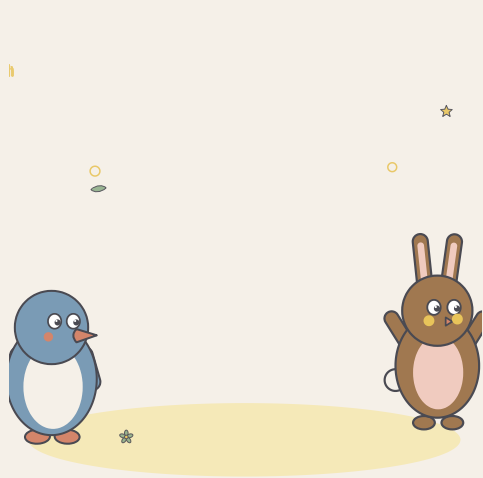
Some words describe the action itself. Nora does not just hop — she hops **quickly**. Toby does not just speak — he speaks **softly**. These words tell us how something is done. Many of them end in a tidy little -ly.



🌿 Walk slowly, then walk quickly. Feel the difference!

Slowly, quickly, softly

Listen to how things are done. A snail moves **slowly**. A rocket zooms **quickly**. Pip speaks **softly**. Nora laughs **loudly**. Each word tells us more about the action — how it happens, not just that it happens.



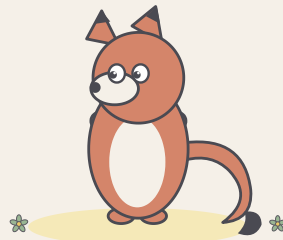
🍃 Say how you can clap: softly, then loudly!

Words that tell how are adverbs

Think of the -ly words.

slowly, quickly, softly, gently. Each one tells

more about a verb — how, when, or where it happens. Words that describe an action have a name of their own.



Words that tell how, when, or where are called adverbs.



🍃 Do an action and add an adverb: hop gently!

When and where, too

Adverbs can tell when: **today**, **soon**, **now**. They can tell where: **here**, **outside**, **everywhere**. **Toby naps now. Luna flies outside.** These little words slot in to tell us more about when and where the action happens.



🍃 Say where you are sitting right now: I am sitting here.

Describe Toby, then how he moves

Look at Toby. Pick three adjectives for him — maybe **big**, **green**, and **calm**. Now add an adverb for how he might move: does he walk **slowly** or hop **happily**? There is no wrong answer. Every word you choose is a good one.

...



🍃 Can you think of one adjective and one adverb for Toby?

You can describe anything!

Remember your
describing words?

Adjectives describe
nouns, like a **soft** bear.

Adverbs describe
verbs, like hopping
gently. Together they
paint the whole picture
— what things are like,
and how they happen.

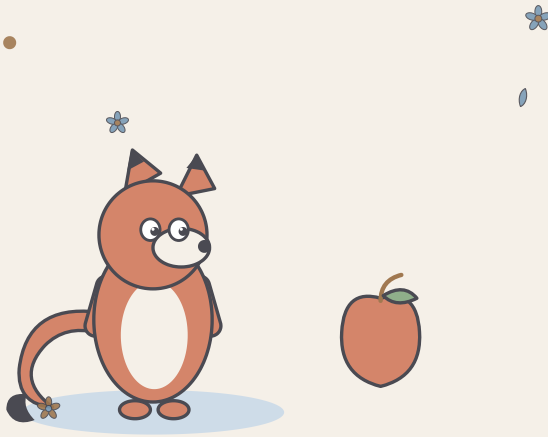


Remember one adjective and one adverb. Use them today!



PART 6





The tiny words before things

Right before a noun, a tiny word often waits: **a**, **an**, or **the**. **a fox** means any fox. **the fox** means that special one. We use **an** before a wide-open sound, like **an apple**. So small, so useful!



🍃 Say the apple, then an apple. Can you hear the difference?

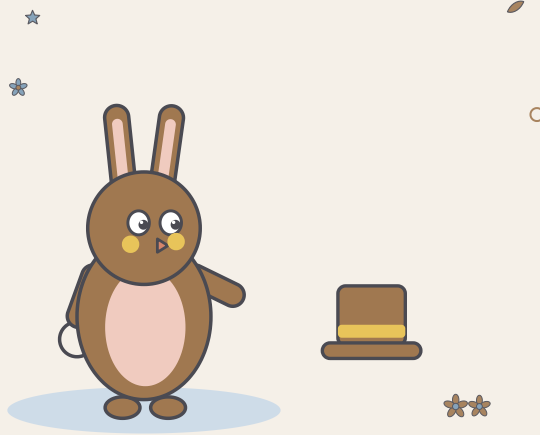


A fox. The fox. An apple.

Watch the tiny words at work. **A fox** trotted by. **The fox** looked back. It found **an apple** and **a box**. We say an before apple because it begins with a wide-open sound. Your ear already knows which to use.



 Say a or an before these: egg, dog, owl, ball.



Pointing and counting words

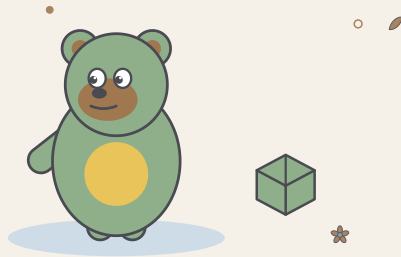
Other little words come before nouns too. Some point at one thing: **this** hat, **that** tree. Some point at more: **these** hats, **those** trees. Some count: **some** stars, **many** friends. Each one helps us say exactly which thing we mean.



🍃 Point and say this, then point far away and say that.

Little words before nouns

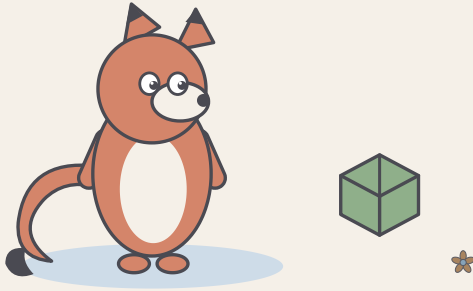
Think of all those tiny words: **a**, **the**, **this**, **that**, **some**. Each one sits just before a noun and helps point it out. Words that do this job have a name of their own.



Words that come before a noun to point it out are called determiners.



 Say a determiner and a noun together, like this hat.



Where things are

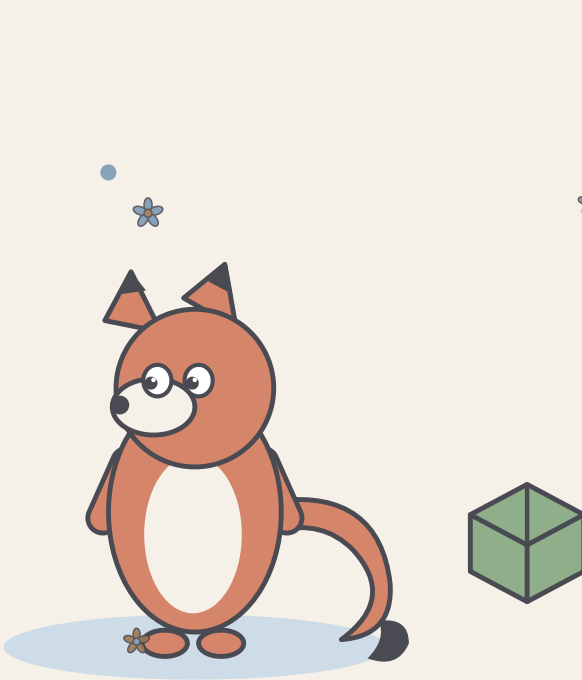
Some little words tell us where. **in** the box. **on** the box. **under** the box. **beside** the box. These words place things in space, like a tiny map made of sounds. You use them to say exactly where something is.



🍃 Put your hand on your head, then under your chin.

In, on, under the box

Milo loves a good box. He hops **in** the box. He climbs **on** the box. He hides **under** the box. He peeks **behind** the box. Each little word tells you just where to look for him.

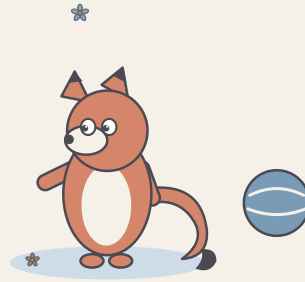


🍃 Hide a toy in, on, and under something. Say where each time.

Words that tell where

Think of the placing words. **in**, **on**, **under**, **over**, **beside**, **behind**.

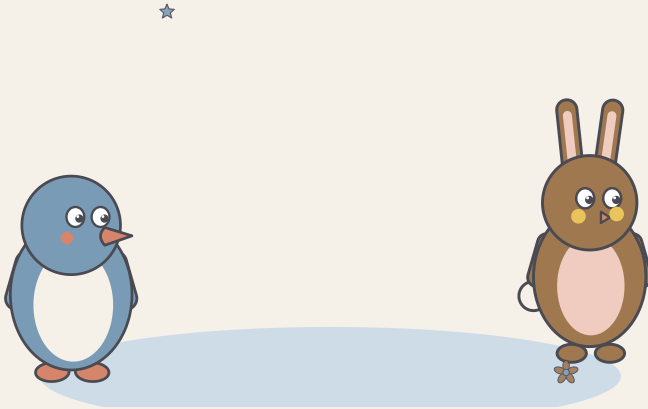
Each one tells where something is, like a tiny direction. Words that do this have a special name.



Words that tell where something is are called prepositions.



🍃 Say where your shoe is using one placing word.



Words that join

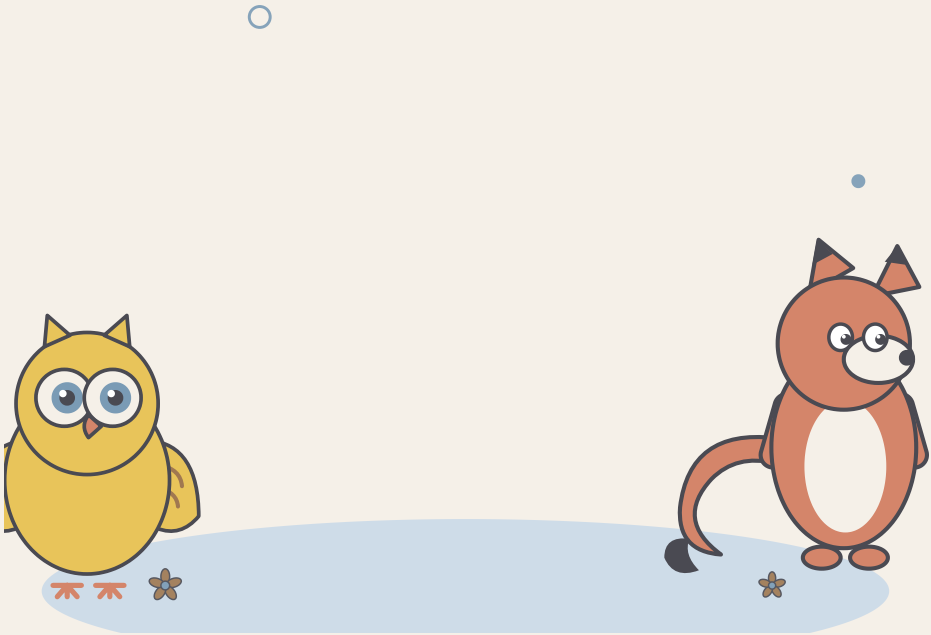
Some little words join other words together. The friendliest is **and**. **Pip and Nora**. **bread and butter**. There is also **or**, for choosing: **tea or milk**. And **but**, for a surprise: **small but strong**. These words link our ideas.



 Name two foods you like, joined with **and**.

And, or, but

Joining words bring ideas together. **Pip and Nora** play in the snow. Would you like **milk or juice**? Toby is **small but strong**. With and we add, with or we choose, and with but we add a little surprise.

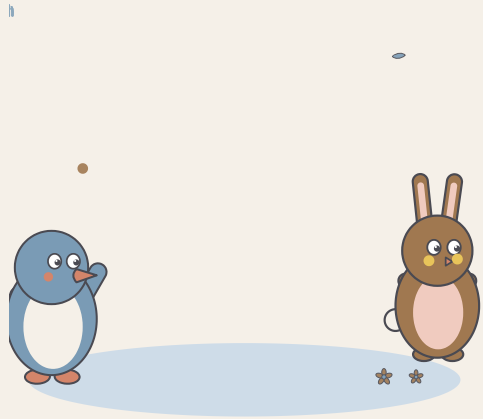


🍃 Would you like to jump or clap? Choose with or!

Words that join are conjunctions

Think of the joining words. **and**, **or**, **but**.

Each one links words or ideas together, like a little bridge. Words that do this job have a name of their own.



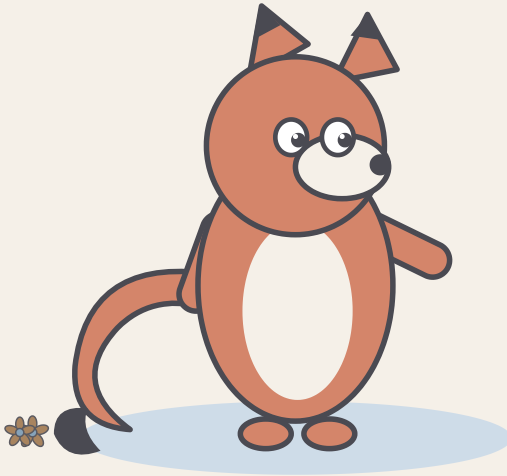
Words that join words or ideas are called conjunctions.



Join two of your favourite things with the word and.

Spot the little word!

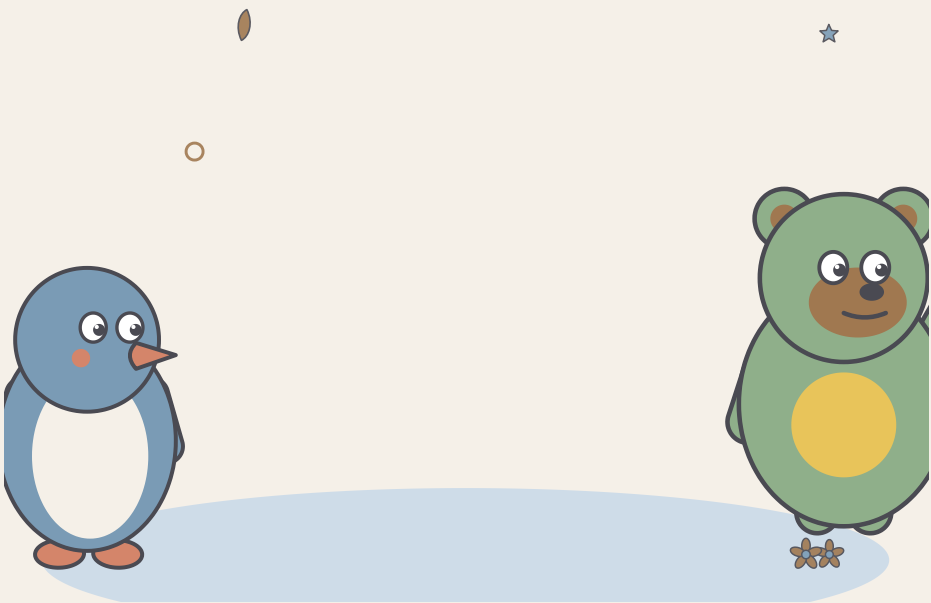
Listen like a detective. In **the cat sat on a mat**, how many little helpers can you hear? There is **the**, and **on**, and **a**. They are small, but they do big jobs. Say the sentence and catch each one.



🍃 Spot one little word in a sentence someone says to you.

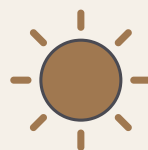
Even tiny words do big jobs!

Remember the little helpers? **Determiners** like a and this come before nouns. **Prepositions** like in and on tell where. **Conjunctions** like and and but join ideas. Tiny words, mighty jobs — every sentence needs them.

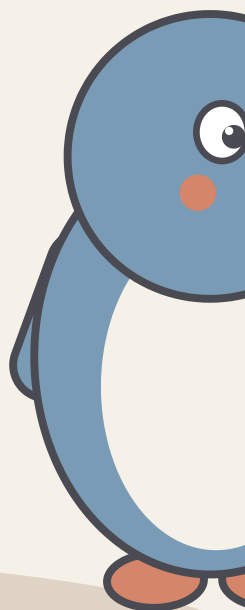


Remember one little word. Use it in a sentence!

PART 7



Building Ideas





Every sentence has two jobs

A whole sentence does two jobs at once. First it tells who or what we mean. Then it tells what happens.

Pip / sleeps. The sun / is warm. Two parts, working as a team, make one complete idea.



🍃 Say a tiny sentence. Can you hear its two parts?



Who or what it is about

The first job names who or what we are talking about. We call it the subject. In **Toby runs**, the subject is **Toby**. In **The ball rolls**, the subject is **the ball**. It is the star of the sentence — the one the sentence is about.

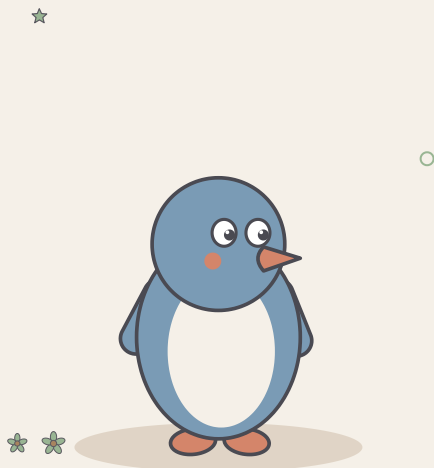
✎ Say a sentence about Toby. Who is it about?

Pip sat. The sun was bright.

The subject is always the who or what. **Pip** sat down. **The sun** was bright. **Nora** laughed. **My friend** waved. Cover the rest of the sentence with your finger — what is left is the subject.



🍃 Point to the subject: The dog barked.



What happens

The second job tells what the subject does or is. We call it the predicate. In **Pip sat down**, the predicate is **sat down**. In **Luna is wise**, it is **is wise**. It is the part with all the action and the news.



🍃 Say what Pip does. That part is the predicate!

Luna found a star

The predicate tells the news about the subject. Pip **sat down**. Luna **found a star**. Toby **ate his lunch**. Nora **hopped away**. It answers the question: what happened? Everything but the subject is the predicate.



🍃 Say what you did today. That is your predicate!

Subject and predicate make a sentence

Now you can see how it fits together. The **subject** is who or what. The **predicate** is what happens. Snap them together and you have a whole, complete sentence — every single time.



Subject + predicate = a complete sentence.



🍃 Build a sentence: pick a subject, then add what it does.



Sentences that belong together

When a few sentences are about the same idea, they like to live together in a little group called a paragraph. One sentence starts the idea. The next adds more. The last finishes it. Together, they tell a tiny, tidy story.



🍃 Say two sentences about the same thing, one after another.

Three sentences, one idea

Here is a tiny paragraph. **Nora loves to hop. She hops over logs. She even hops in her dreams!** Three sentences, all about one thing: Nora and her hopping. That is how a paragraph holds an idea together.



🍃 Tell a three-sentence story about something you love.

Build a sentence about Toby

You are the builder now. Start with a subject: **Toby**.
Add a predicate — what does he do? **Toby eats honey. Toby naps in the sun.** Say your sentence out loud. You just built a complete idea, all by yourself!



🍃 Build one more sentence about Toby and say it proudly.

You can build anything!

Remember how sentences are built? A **subject** tells who or what. A **predicate** tells what happens. Put a few sentences together about one idea and you have a **paragraph**. You can build whole stories now.





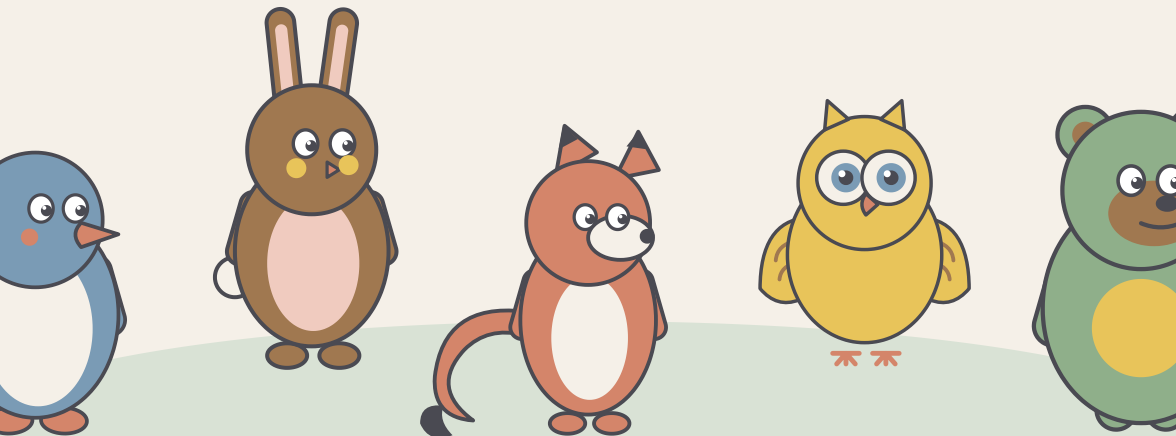
Remember the two parts of a sentence. Name them both!



PART 8



Grammar Adventure



Everything you know

Look how far you have come! You know **nouns** and **pronouns**, **verbs** and **adjectives**, **adverbs** and helpful little words like **prepositions** and **conjunctions**. You can even spot a feeling **interjection**. Every page proved the same happy thing: you already knew it.



Remember your favourite word family. Say one example!



Pip's Big Question

One morning **Pip** looked up and asked, **Why is the sky so blue?** It was a real question, so it ended with a curious mark. Pip is a **noun** — a name. asked is a **verb** — an action. You can see the grammar hiding inside the story!



🍃 Find the question mark in Pip's question. Point to it!

Pip's Big Question

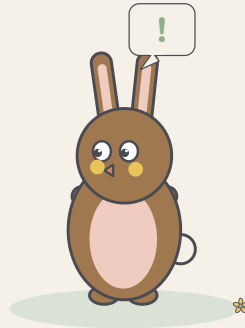
Luna flew down to help. **Nobody knows for sure**, she said **softly**. Here is a proper noun (Luna), a **verb** (flew), and an **adverb** (softly, telling us how). One little story, full of every kind of word you have learned.



🍃 Can you find a verb in this story? Say it out loud.

Nora Finds a Word

Nora hopped through the tall grass. I found a word! she shouted loudly. It was the word jump — and jump is a verb! So Nora did exactly that. She jumped for joy, past, present, and future all in one happy hop.



🍃 Act out the verb Nora found. Can you jump too?



Nora Finds a Word

Milo ran over. **Let me see it!** he said. Together they built a whole sentence: **Nora jumps high.** **Nora** is the subject. **jumps high** is the predicate. Two friends, two jobs, one perfect sentence.



🍃 Point to the subject and the predicate in **Nora jumps high.**

Find it on this page!

Time for a treasure hunt! On this very page, can you find: one **noun**, one **verb**, and one **adjective**? Hint: a noun names something, a verb is an action, and an adjective describes. Point to each treasure as you find it.



🍃 Find one noun, one verb, and one adjective on this page!

Find it all around you!

One more hunt — this time around the room! Can you find a **noun** to point at? An **action** to do? A **describing** word to whisper? A **little word** like the or on? The whole world is full of grammar, waiting for you to notice it.



🍃 Find a noun, do a verb, and say an adjective — all around you!



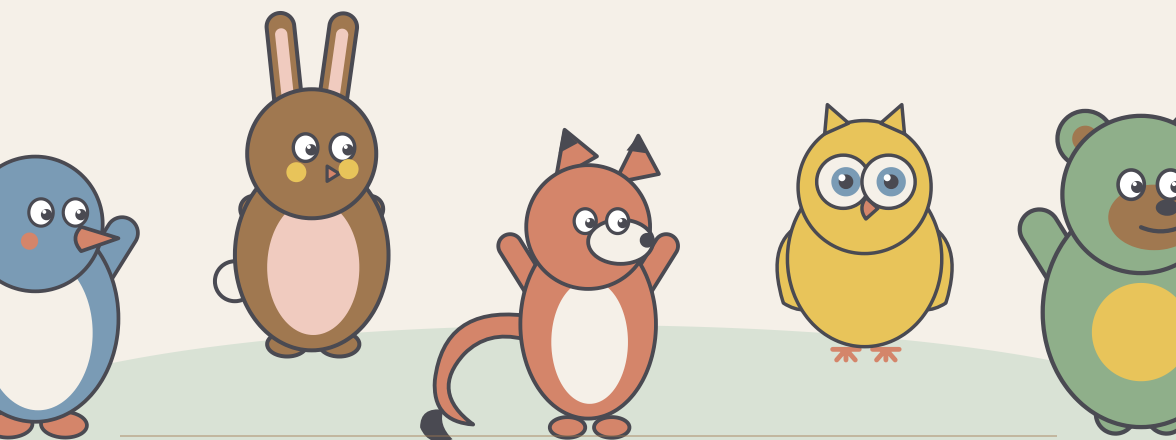
The whole word family

Here is your word family, all together. **Nouns** name. **Pronouns** stand in. **Verbs** do. **Adjectives** and **adverbs** describe. **Determiners**, **prepositions**, and **conjunctions** help. And **interjections** show feeling. Nine kinds of words — and you know them all!



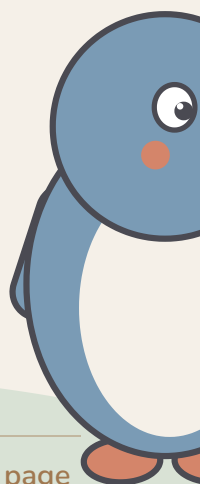
Remember the nine kinds of words. How many can you name?

You're a grammar explorer!



🍃 Clap five times — one for each friend who explored with you!

The End — and the Beginning



🍃 Show someone one thing you learned. Then start again from page one!

FROM ME TO YOU

Turns out writing a book is easier than convincing someone to publish it.

So I skipped that part.

I wrote these books for my favourite people. Since you're here, I'm assuming that's you.

They're free until a publisher discovers my existence, offers me a contract, and starts sending royalty cheques.

Enjoy the book. If you like it, drop me a note. If you love it—or if it sparks a new idea for someone you love—Hot Wheels and LEGO remain valid currency in my kingdom.

 **dio.stesso**

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